11.6 Diabetic and Venous Leg Ulcers

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • "The wound on my leg has been open for months." **Objective** • Venous ulcer above the inner ankle • Swelling • Skin stained brown	**ACTUAL** **Impaired tissue integrity** related to venous insufficiency as evidenced by chronic open ulcer.	Within 4 weeks the ulcer is smaller.	• Measure the ulcer every week. • Do an ABPI before compression, as ordered. • Apply compression bandaging as prescribed. • Teach her to keep the leg raised.	Ulcer smaller: **goal met**.
Subjective • "The bandages are uncomfortable." **Objective** • Does not want to wear compression • Takes the bandages off at night	**ACTUAL** **Ineffective health self-management** related to discomfort of compression therapy as evidenced by removing bandages.	Keeps the compression on as prescribed.	• Explain how compression helps the ulcer heal. • Check the bandage fits well and is comfortable. • Teach walking and ankle exercises.	Keeps it on: **goal met**.
Subjective • *No specific complaint* **Objective** • Wound has been open a long time	**RISK** **Risk for infection** as evidenced by risk factors: chronic open wound.	Ulcer stays free of infection.	• Watch for more pain, a smell, more exudate and spreading redness. • If infection is suspected, take a swab.	No infection: **goal met**.